

COURSEWORK 2 - Brand Analysis using BlueSky

Coursework Release Date: Friday, 20th March 2026

Coursework Deadline Date: Thursday, 30th April 2026, 3pm

Coursework Submission: via Moodle coursework submission link on the ASA web page

Practical Completion Deadline Date: Friday, 27th March 2026, 2pm

Practical Completion Check: TAs to check during support sessions

Coursework-related questions: via email to georgiana.nica-avram1@nottingham.ac.uk

Q&A Session: 20th March 2026

1. The Problem Definition:

In this coursework, you have been asked by KantarIQ, a brand-tracking company, to do an exploratory “snapshot” analysis of the public’s view of two specific brands - as seen through the lens of social media (BlueSky). This is because the company itself is going to begin producing related/complementary products themselves, and so wish to undertake this first exploratory analysis. You are tasked with:

1. Collecting BlueSky posts referring to those two brands/products/services, between 1,000 - 2,000 posts for each entity.
2. Unpacking those posts’ contents, and from these providing perceptual maps to see the position of brands in the minds of consumers. The perceptual mapping might include an exploration of:
 - prevalence of mentions;
 - types of users mentioning the brands;
 - companies promoting the brands;
 - key descriptive words occurring in relation to the brands;
 - topics arising in relation to the brands;
 - general sentiment surrounding the posts;
 - sentiment towards selected features of the (products of) two brands;

The choice is open and yours, and you are not expected to cover all of these in a pilot, exploratory analysis.

3. Identifying one candidate BlueSky micro-influencer for each of the two brands whom you believe may be good for the company to engage with in the next stage of the pilot.
4. Completing a report (maximum 3000 words) summarising these analyses.

N.b. Importantly, you are free to choose the Brand/Product that you would like to examine.

You absolutely must select two well-known brands, products, entertainers or institutions (this might be, but certainly not constrained to, leading makeup brands or products, car brands, sporting team brands, etc. - please select carefully, as it must be brands/products that generate posts). It would

also be preferable if these brands are each others' competitor so that you can investigate them in parallel/ compare and contrast.

Note also this is a 'snapshot' pilot analysis - not a full in-depth study!

Inevitably, some of your analysis will be more qualitative than if you had tens of thousands of posts to analyse. Similarly, you are not expected to find a perfect-micro-influencer - merely someone who is a justifiable starting point based on metrics that you specify.

Quantitative analysis is mandatory to undertake in some form. Those techniques can involve any analytics approaches you have learnt and would like to apply (whether it be geospatial, text analysis, sentiment analysis, time series analysis, etc., or any combination).

2. Expected Approach:

- It is expected that your data collection approach will use a python script (much in the same way as the practical from "ASA Week 7 - case study exercises"). This is a key part of the assessment. If you want to source additional posts outside of those collected directly by your python scripts, you must get clearance to do this from me.
- BlueSky posts, once obtained by your scripts, must be saved in an appropriate form (you will be required to submit your data as part of your submission).
- Under absolutely no circumstances may you pay to acquire BlueSky posts.
- You must clarify which data sets you will use for your analysis via email.
- The chosen data may be analysed in any form you see fit - you may analyse it to evidence reach, mentions, attitudes to the product, sentiment associated with the brands, indeed anything you think may be relevant to understanding the brands. However, as detailed above, you must apply some form of analytics technique during this process, rather than taking a purely qualitative approach.
- You may also augment your report and presentation using information from market reports about your chosen brands if you so desire. I do not recommend spending too much time here, as these contextual insights will only contribute towards the executive summary and conclusion marks.
- You are expected to find two appropriate micro-influencers by selecting some metrics that support your choice, and also obtaining these via analysis of the posts.

3. Report Structure

To present your exploration, you will provide a report of this snapshot pilot study that clearly describes your target brands, the approach and techniques you have taken to underpin your work, and the results of that analysis (including visualisations where appropriate). You must also identify one potential candidate micro-influencer for each brand to engage with (along with some form of justification), before wrapping up your insights in a final conclusion section. Expected sections are as follows:

1. **Executive Summary:** including a description of the task, a summary of your technical approach, a summary of the data that underpins it, a summary of the results, and a summary of the insights you have arrived at.
2. **Approach breakdown:** a summary of the process that you have undertaken to analyse data, to summarise results, and to draw conclusions.
3. **Data Collection section:** A summary section quickly detailing the data you have acquired, and upon which your analysis is based. This should, at the absolute minimum, include information on the number of BlueSky posts obtained, your search terms, the number of unique users analysed, the date range and the geographical area focused on (this may be global, but please do specify).

4. **Analysis section:** In this section, which will comprise the bulk of your report, you must summarise your investigations. Please feel free to split this into different subsections based on the techniques you examined, or angles you took to considering the text surrounding posts, the locations they were produced from, and the people/companies that were mentioning them.
5. **Micro-influencer recommendation:** Here, you will provide a summary of the BlueSky users you recommend to the company to engage with concerning the brands.
6. **Conclusion:** A brief conclusion summarising the key parts of your analysis, and any recommendations you have for the brands if they were to extend this pilot study into a full analysis.

4. What you need to submit

- 5 marks are available for the completion of the network analytics, market influencers and text analytics practicals on weeks 5, 6, and 7. These will be checked by the teaching assistants during the dedicated support sessions.
- A report on your exploration - 3000 words maximum AND 8 pages maximum. See the report section for the structure and to understand what is expected.
- All code / notebooks / tableau files. I expect:
 - A commented Jupyter notebook containing the code that loads in these posts, and performs analysis on them that you then describe in your report.

5. How to submit

- All files must be zipped into one file. Submission is electronically via Moodle.
 - DUE DATE: Thursday 30th April 2026, 3.00pm UK time

6. Tips

- Pick brands that you find interesting, or might be relevant to your future goals.
- Do a good descriptive analysis of the text
- To analyse posts, *you might want to do some simple counts, word counts, etc. You may also find some inspiration from the example case study exercises in "ASA Week 07 - Text analytics" and "ASA Week 05 - Topic Modelling".*
- Store your posts into a data structure that is easy to save to file. *You might use a pandas dataframe or your own structure saved as a csv. Whatever you find easiest to work with and load into.*
- *Start your analysis approach on a small number of posts, and just get something working - you can always rerun once your code for analysis is in place.*
- Don't try to do too much - *think what would be a neat, contained and informative pilot summary. This is, after all, only a 'snapshot' (and equally your micro-influencers chosen just needs to be justified and reasonable)*